

2026 HEAT STRESS

ACTION TEMPLATE

REG STATUS: Federal Heat Standard not yet final — OSHA enforcing NOW via General Duty Clause.
80°F/90°F triggers in use. The rule is coming. Citations are already here. \$16,550 per violation.

DAILY HEAT CHECK

WBGT METER OR OSHA HEAT INDEX APP

- ☐ **UNDER 80°F** Monitor for symptoms. Train staff on heat illness signs and emergency reporting.
- ☐ **80°F INITIAL** 32 oz cool water/employee/hr · Shade or AC break access · Acclimatize new hires 5–7 days
- ☐ **90°F HIGH** 15-min rest per 2 hrs · Buddy system · Cooling PPE · Medical monitoring active

REQUIRED CONTROLS BY TRIGGER LEVEL

TRIGGER	WATER	REST / SHADE	ACCLIMATIZATION	EMERGENCY
80°F INITIAL	32 oz/hr cool water	Shade or AC access nearby	5–7 days gradual exposure	Heat stroke response plan on-site and trained
90°F HIGH	Electrolytes acceptable	15 min per 2 hrs mandatory	Full protocol must be active	Medical monitoring required — designate lead

WRITTEN PLAN CHECKLIST

OSHA INSPECTOR MUST-SEES

- ☐ **HIIPP** Heat Illness and Injury Prevention Plan (HIIPP) documented, signed, and current.
- ☐ **TRAINING** Employee training records: symptoms, reporting, first response. Date-stamped.
- ☐ **LOGS** Environmental monitoring logs: temperature and humidity recorded daily.
- ☐ **EMERGENCY** Emergency response plan: cool-down area, first aid contacts, 911 protocol posted on-site.
- ☐ **ACCL** Acclimatization records for new or returning workers — first two weeks of heat season.
- ☐ **BUDDY** Buddy system assignments documented and posted for all 90°F+ work days.

ENFORCEMENT NOTE: NC DOL cites under General Duty Clause today. \$16,550 per violation.

Inspectors check written plans and monitoring logs on-site. Preparation is the only defense.



READY FOR AN INSPECTOR?

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